

Motorola Moto G42

Impressive phone, but not for power users

Motorola has also been a solid player in the Indian budget phone market and with the launch of the Moto G42, they've added another option for users under ₹15K. It proves to be a tough competition to phones under this price bracket. Well, at least, on paper. How does the phone hold up in real life and is it a viable option under ₹15,000? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Moto G42 is extremely lightweight; only 174.5 g. It is also pretty thin at 8.26 mm. This makes it one of the more lean and streamlined phones in its price range. It feels good in the hand, but the edges are slightly sharp which can be a tad uncomfortable.

The back panel sports a premium glass-like finish. However, it's very prone to smudges and it is slippery. The fingerprint sensor is embedded in the power button and it worked flawlessly throughout our testing. The volume buttons are a bit difficult to reach if you have smaller hands. The phone also has stereo speakers on the top and bottom. You also get IP52 dust and water resistance.

DISPLAY

The Moto G42 rocks a 6.4-inch AMOLED display with Full HD+ resolution. However, there's no high refresh rate support. It produces good visuals with pretty accurate colours and good viewing angles. You get good screen legibility, even in sunlight, which is a win at this price point. FHD+ content pops and looks vivid with true blacks due to the AMOLED screen. The display is immersive enough and the stereo speakers with Dolby Atmos support add to this. The display, however, isn't HDR certified but it does come with Widevine L1 support.

PERFORMANCE

The Motorola Moto G42 is powered by



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the Qualcomm Snapdragon 680 SoC, paired with 4 GB LPDDR4x RAM and 64 GB uMCP internal storage.

The internal memory is also expandable up to 1 TB via a microSD card. In real-world usage, the Moto G42 performs without hitches for most basic tasks. However, multitasking is another ball game where the G42's 4 GB RAM proves to be a deterrent. Basically, don't expect more than 3-4 apps to run concurrently without hitches.

CAMERA

The camera experience is crucial in smartphones, no matter the price, but, unfortunately, this is where the Moto G42 fails to live up to expectations. In daylight, the primary lens outputs decent HDR shots with good colours and sharpness. However, the dynamic range is not the best we've tested at this price – details in shadows are often crushed and highlights are often over-exposed. There's a 50 MP mode as well which outputs unbinned images with more clarity but the dynamic range drops even further. Indoor images look

decent, but in low light, the Moto G42's images are extremely noisy and soft, even with Night Mode active, which is disappointing. The ultrawide lens, outputs mediocre images and the colour is not consistent with the primary lens. Selfies are, again, mediocre with good colour but blown-out highlights. Night-time selfies are grainy and noisy. For video, the footage is not the best, once again, when it comes to dynamic range and sharpness. Overall, the camera experience is mediocre.

BATTERY

The Moto G42 has you covered on the battery front. The phone is equipped with a sizable 5,000 mAh cell with a 20 W TurboPower charger provided in the box. Do note that the phone only supports 18 W charging though. In our tests, 15 minutes of playing Call of Duty: Mobile drained the battery by 4 per cent from 82 per cent. Viewing Netflix for 30 minutes drained the battery by another 6 per cent from 77 per cent. The charging speeds are slow as you only get 18 W fast charging support.

VERDICT

The Motorola Moto G42 is an extremely impressive smartphone under ₹15,000. Not only do you get a premium-looking smartphone, but you also get an array of features such as an AMOLED display, stereo speakers with Dolby support, near Stock Android experience, good battery life, and decent real-world performance. All at the competitive price. The Moto G42 offers a pretty balanced experience across the board; with the exception of its camera system.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

OPERATING SYSTEM: Android 12 | INTERNAL STORAGE: 64 GB, expandable up to 1 TB | RAM: 4 GB LPDDR4x | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 680 | BATTERY SIZE: 5000 mAh non-removable | CHARGER TYPE: 20W TurboPower charger | DISPLAY SIZE: 6.4-inch | REFRESH RATE: 60 Hz | RESOLUTION: FHD+ (2400 x 1080) | DISPLAY TECHNOLOGY: AMOLED | WEIGHT: 174 g | THICKNESS: 8.26 mm | IP RATING: IP52 | CAMERAS: 50 MP + 8 MP + 2 MP, 16 MP selfie | VIDEO: FHD at 30 fps

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